

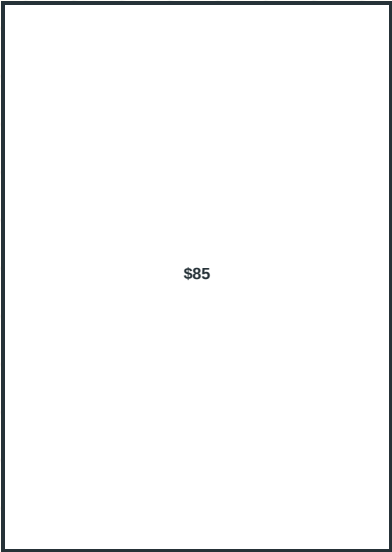
Manila Folder Story Clue Trail Card Pack

Sixteen manila folder cards help writers connect a first clue, next clue, turning clue, mismatch, return clue, and broad folder label note.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable manila folder story clue-trail cards plus adult guide tools, clue-trail routines, take-home clue slips, and optional adult prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline clue trail practice.



\$85

Included

- 16 printable manila folder clue trail cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional clue-trail safety notes
- First clue prompts
- Next clue prompts
- Turning clue prompts
- Mismatch and return clue prompts
- Six adult-led clue-trail routines
- Ten take-home clue slips
- Printable PDF and ZIP artifact

Clue trail coaching

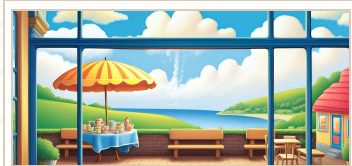
Manila Folder Clue Trail Adult Guide

- Set out one manila folder, blank pages, pencils, and a paper clue trail card before the adult-led start: _____.
- Choose one made-up world and remind the writer that every clue stays invented, broad, and paper-only: _____.
- Move through first clue, next clue, turning clue, mismatch clue, return clue, and folder label in order: _____.
- Keep the adult in charge of the folder while the child writes or dictates short page notes: _____.
- Use pretend objects, places, and actions only; do not ask for real schedules, rooms, names, or personal facts: _____.
- Close by reading the folder label and choosing one next-page clue for a later adult-led paper pass: _____.

Use one manila folder clue trail card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, paper-only, and guided by an adult.

Sixteen clue trail card worlds

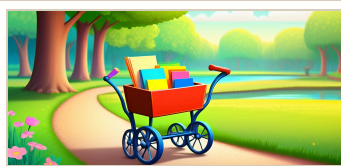
Pick a world image, then connect one fictional page move with a pretend manila folder clue trail card.



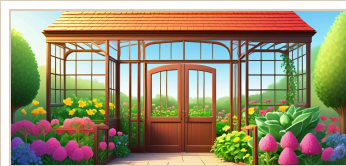
AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



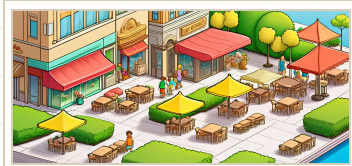
AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



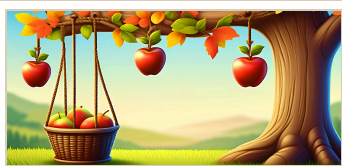
AGES 7-9
Sticker Station Mail Cart



AGES 10-11
Chapter Gate Greenhouse



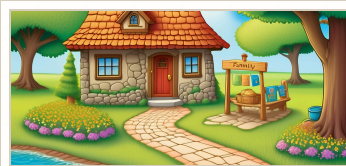
AGES 7-9
Paperclip Plaza Parcel Day



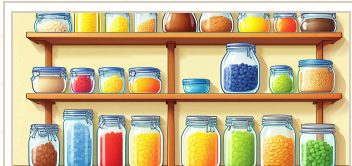
AGES 8-10
Orchard Pulley Post



AGES 10-11
Appendix Archive Lab



AGES 7-9
Penny Path Compass Shop



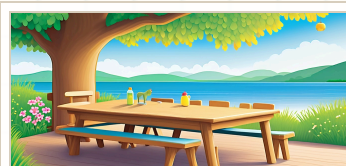
AGES 8-10
Pantry Measurement Mystery



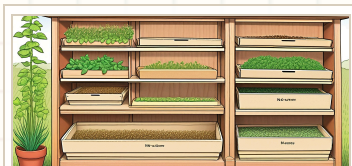
AGES 10-11
Blue Pencil Observatory



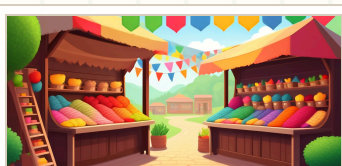
AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



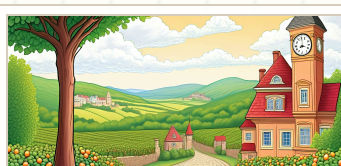
AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk



AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 7-8
Mitten Market Lost Ticket



AGES 8-10
Cloudberry Clocktower



AGES 7-9
Rain Boot Route Rangers

Choose the manila folder routine

SHORT FIRST-PAGE SETUP First Clue Folder Start Manila folder, blank page, pencil, and first-clue card. 1. The adult opens the manila folder and points to the first clue blank: _____. 2. The child chooses one made-up object, place hint, or action: _____. 3. The adult asks how that clue starts the pretend page: _____. 4. The child writes or dictates one first clue line on paper: _____. The clue trail begins with this pretend first clue: _____.	ONE-PAGE CONTINUATION Next Clue Step Manila folder, current page, next blank page, and pencil. 1. The adult points from the first clue to the next clue blank: _____. 2. The child chooses one clue that follows on paper: _____. 3. The adult asks what should stay connected from the first clue: _____. 4. The child writes one next clue line on the page: _____. The next clue follows because: _____.
GENTLE CLUE TURN Turning Clue Pass Manila folder, clue card, pencil, and small paper strip. 1. The adult rereads the first two paper clues: _____. 2. The child invents one calm turn that changes the clue trail: _____. 3. The adult asks what the page should notice after the turn: _____. 4. The child writes the turning clue on a paper strip: _____. The turning clue changes the paper trail with: _____.	CONNECTION CHECK Mismatch Check Manila folder, two clue notes, and mismatch blank. 1. The adult points to one clue that almost fits the page: _____. 2. The child names what feels mismatched in the pretend trail: _____. 3. The adult asks how a new paper clue could fix the connection: _____. 4. The child writes the mismatch clue and one repair idea: _____. The mismatch clue now needs this paper fix: _____.
CONTINUITY RETURN Return Clue Loop Earlier page, blank page, pencil, and manila folder. 1. The adult reopens one earlier clue from the folder: _____. 2. The child chooses a pretend clue to bring back: _____. 3. The adult asks where the returning clue belongs on the next page: _____. 4. The child writes one return clue line that connects the trail: _____. The return clue brings back this pretend piece: _____.	PAPER WRAP PASS Folder Label Close Manila folder, folder label slip, page stack, and pencil. 1. The adult lays the clue trail pages beside the manila folder: _____. 2. The child chooses a broad pretend folder label for the trail: _____. 3. The adult reads the label and asks what next-page clue it suggests: _____. 4. The child tucks the folder label slip into the manila folder: _____. The folder label closes this clue trail with: _____.

Try one clue trail later

TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 1 Adult: open the manila folder and ask for one pretend first clue: _____.	TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 2 Child: the first clue on my paper trail is: _____.
TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 3 Adult: point from the first clue to the next clue blank: _____.	TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 4 Child: the next clue should show: _____.
TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 5 Adult: ask what calm turning clue changes the page: _____.	TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 6 Child: my turning clue says: _____.
TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 7 Adult: ask which clue almost fits but needs a repair note: _____.	TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 8 Child: the mismatch clue can be fixed by: _____.
TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 9 Adult: reread one earlier clue and ask what can return: _____.	TAKE-HOME CLUE SLIP Clue slip 10 Child: the folder label for this pretend trail is: _____.

- Optional adult prompts**
- Optional adult-led paper prompt: the first clue in the manila folder is _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the next clue follows because _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the turning clue changes the page when _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the mismatch clue needs this repair _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the return clue brings back _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the folder label should say _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the next page clue could be _____.
 - Optional adult-led paper prompt: the clue trail closes with _____.

Teacup Town Weather Window Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend weather-window clue trail card on the table: _____.

Writer: follow the clue trail on paper by making each Teacup Town clue pretend and broad: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

First clue
First clue: write the tiny weather sign seen through the teacup window, such as a paper cloud tag:

Next clue
Next clue: add the paper clue that follows the first window sign inside the manila folder:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm page moment when the weather-window clue starts to mean something new:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one pretend sign that almost fits the clue trail but needs a clearer page note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first weather-window sign so the later page connects to the start:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Teacup Town manila folder clue trail:

Quiet option: fill only the first clue and folder label blanks before adding more clue trail notes: _____. **Take-home line:** restart this paper clue trail later with one pretend teacup-window folder label: _____.

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend dock-token clue trail card where the writer can reach them: _____.

Writer: keep the spoon ferry clue trail fully invented while each clue moves across the page: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

First clue
First clue: write the pretend dock token, ferry mark, or folded harbor signal that starts the clue trail:

Next clue
Next clue: add the paper clue that appears after the spoon ferry reaches the next made-up harbor stop:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the dock token changes what the helper understands:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one pretend harbor clue that seems close but belongs on a different page note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first dock token or ferry mark with a clearer meaning:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail at the harbor:

Quiet option: write only the first dock token and the return clue before the adult closes the folder: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper clue trail later with one spoon-ferry folder label: _____.

Sticker Station Mail Cart Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend sticker-sort clue trail card: _____.

Writer: follow the mail cart clue trail with pretend sticker slips and paper-only page notes: _____.



Sticker Station Mail Cart

First clue
First clue: choose the first pretend sticker slip on the cart and write what it seems to mean:

Next clue
Next clue: add the paper clue that follows when the cart reaches the next made-up station:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm page turn when the sticker slip points to a new clue:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one pretend sticker mark that almost matches but needs a different clue trail note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first sticker slip so the later page connects to the first clue:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Sticker Station manila folder clue trail:

Quiet option: circle the first sticker clue and write only the folder label blank for now: _____. **Take-home line:** start another paper clue trail later with one pretend sticker-cart folder label: _____.

Chapter Gate Greenhouse Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place the manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend greenhouse-gate clue trail card beside the writer: _____.

Writer: build the clue trail with invented gate marks, plant tags, and page notes that stay paper-only: _____.



Chapter Gate Greenhouse

First clue
First clue: write the first pretend gate mark, hinge note, or greenhouse tag that starts the page:

Next clue
Next clue: add the paper clue that follows the gate mark deeper into the made-up greenhouse:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the gate clue changes direction or meaning:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one pretend greenhouse tag that almost fits but needs a corrected page note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first gate mark so the clue trail links back to the beginning:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Chapter Gate manila folder clue trail:

Quiet option: list only the first gate clue and the return clue inside the manila folder: _____. **Take-home line:** reopen this paper clue trail later with one pretend greenhouse folder label: _____.

Paperclip Plaza Parcel Day Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set a manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend clipped-parcel clue trail card on the table: _____.

Writer: keep every parcel clue pretend while the clue trail moves from one paper note to the next: _____.



Paperclip Plaza Parcel Day

First clue
First clue: write the pretend paperclip mark or parcel tag that starts the plaza clue trail:

Next clue
Next clue: add the page clue that follows after the parcel tag shifts, folds, or points onward:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the clipped parcel clue points somewhere unexpected on the page: _____.

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one pretend parcel tag that nearly fits but belongs under a different clue trail note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first paperclip mark so the parcel page feels connected:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Paperclip Plaza manila folder clue trail:

Quiet option: write the first parcel clue and return clue, then pause the manila folder work: _____. **Take-home line:** continue this paper clue trail later with one pretend parcel-day folder label: _____.

Orchard Pulley Post Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a manila folder, blank page, pencil, and pretend pulley-post clue trail card beside the paper: _____.

Writer: follow the orchard clue trail by inventing paper pulley marks, post notes, and a broad folder label: _____.



Orchard Pulley Post

First clue First clue: write the pretend pulley mark or post tag that starts the orchard page: _____.	Next clue Next clue: add the paper clue that follows when the pulley mark moves to the next made-up post: _____.
Turning clue Turning clue: invent the calm page moment when the pulley clue changes the path of the clue trail: _____.	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: name one pretend post note that almost fits but needs a new paper clue: _____.
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first pulley mark so the later clue connects to the start: _____.	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Orchard Pulley Post manila folder clue trail: _____.

Quiet option: fill the first clue, return clue, and folder label blanks before adding more: _____. **Take-home line:** restart this paper clue trail later with one pretend orchard folder label: _____.

Appendix Archive Lab Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one manila folder, a blank page, a pencil, and a folder label slip before the clue trail begins: _____.

Writer: invent an archive helper and follow the clue trail on paper without using real names, places, or facts: _____.



Appendix Archive Lab

First clue
First clue: write the first pretend archive mark, such as a folded index tab, shelf dot, or margin arrow:

Next clue
Next clue: add the paper clue that follows from the first mark inside the made-up appendix archive lab:

Turning clue
Turning clue: show the calm moment when the archive helper learns the first clue points to a different paper drawer: _____.

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one clue that almost fits the drawer but needs a new note in the clue trail:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first archive mark and explain how it now helps the helper connect the page:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail: _____.

Quiet option: adult points to the first archive mark, and the writer fills only the return clue blank: _____. **Take-home line:** keep the paper-only clue trail by saving one pretend archive clue under the folder label: _____.

Penny Path Compass Shop Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one manila folder beside a blank compass note, a pencil, and a folder label strip for the clue trail: _____.

Writer: make up a shop helper, a button compass, and a clue trail that stays on paper: _____.



Penny Path Compass Shop

First clue First clue: write what the button compass points to first, such as a penny path mark or folded counter note: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the next paper clue the helper notices near the compass shop counter: _____ _____
Turning clue Turning clue: write how the compass clue turns toward a kinder path or clearer paper mark: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: choose one pretend mark that seems close but does not match the compass clue yet: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first compass point and show how it helps the final page note make sense: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail: _____ _____

Quiet option: adult names the button compass, and the writer writes only the next clue line: _____. **Take-home line:** continue the paper-only clue trail later by keeping one compass clue in the manila folder: _____.

Pantry Measurement Mystery Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one manila folder, a blank measurement page, a pencil, and a folder label slip for the clue trail: _____.

Writer: invent a shelf helper, a measuring ribbon, and a made-up clue trail that stays broad and paper-only: _____.



Pantry Measurement Mystery

First clue First clue: write the first pretend measuring mark, such as three tiny ticks on a ribbon strip: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the next shelf note that follows from the measuring mark on the paper page: _____ _____
Turning clue Turning clue: show how the helper notices the measuring mark points to a different paper tag than expected: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: write one shelf tag that almost matches the ribbon clue but needs another clue trail note: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first measuring mark and explain how it helps sort the pretend mystery: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail: _____ _____

Quiet option: adult circles the measuring mark, and the writer fills only the mismatch blank: _____. **Take-home line:** save one paper measuring clue in the manila folder and restart the clue trail later: _____.

Blue Pencil Observatory Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: open the manila folder, add a blank sky chart page, and place a folder label slip beside the clue trail card: _____.

Writer: invent an observatory helper and use paper clues only as the blue pencil clue trail changes: _____.



Blue Pencil Observatory

First clue First clue: write the first blue pencil mark on the pretend sky chart, such as a tiny arrow or ring: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the next paper chart clue that follows from the first blue pencil mark: _____ _____
Turning clue Turning clue: write the moment the helper realizes the chart mark points to a new paper corner: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: name one sky chart mark that looks useful but does not fit the clue trail yet: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first blue pencil mark and show how the new clue explains it: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail: _____ _____

Quiet option: adult points to the sky chart mark, and the writer writes only the turning clue sentence: _____. **Take-home line:** tuck one paper chart clue into the manila folder under the folder label: _____.

Rain Gauge Railway Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set one manila folder beside a blank rail note, a pencil, and a folder label strip for the clue trail: _____.

Writer: make up a railway helper, a rain gauge ticket, and a paper-only clue trail with no real trip details: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

First clue First clue: write the first pretend gauge mark the helper finds on a small rail ticket: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the next paper rail clue that follows from the gauge mark: _____. _____
Turning clue Turning clue: show how a track note changes what the gauge mark means in the clue trail: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: write one rail card mark that almost fits but sends the helper back to check the page: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first gauge mark and show how the helper connects it to the final rail note: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this manila folder clue trail: _____. _____

Quiet option: adult names the gauge mark, and the writer fills only the return clue blank: _____. **Take-home line:** keep one pretend gauge clue in the manila folder so the paper clue trail can continue later: _____.

Binding Day Boardwalk Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one manila folder, blank page, pencil, and this clue trail card beside a pretend boardwalk page stack: _____.

Writer: follow the clue trail on paper and keep every boardwalk detail invented, broad, and guided by the adult: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

First clue First clue: choose the loose page, ribbon mark, or binding cart detail that starts the boardwalk clue trail: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the paper clue that follows beside the boardwalk binding table in the manila folder: _____ _____
Turning clue Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the page stack changes what the first clue seems to mean: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: name one pretend ribbon, page mark, or cart label that almost fits but needs a new paper note: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first binding clue and show why it belongs in this clue trail: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for the Binding Day Boardwalk manila folder: _____ _____

Quiet option: write only the binding clue, the return clue, and one folder label word for the clue trail: _____.

Take-home line: save the paper in the manila folder and restart the clue trail later with one new boardwalk clue: _____.

Seed Library Map Room Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place this card, a manila folder, blank paper, and pencil beside a pretend map-room shelf note: _____.

Writer: with the adult, move through the clue trail one paper clue at a time and keep the map room invented: _____.



Seed Library Map Room

First clue
First clue: choose the seed drawer mark, map corner symbol, or shelf tag that begins the clue trail:

Next clue
Next clue: add the next paper clue that points from the first map-room mark to a different pretend shelf:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm page moment when the map-room clue points to a surprising paper corner:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: write one seed drawer mark or map symbol that almost matches but needs a clearer note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first map-room mark and explain how it connects the clue trail:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for this Seed Library Map Room manila folder:

Quiet option: copy one map-room mark, one next clue, and one folder label word before adding more: _____. **Take-home line:** tuck the page into the manila folder and add one invented map-room clue later: _____.

Mitten Market Lost Ticket Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: open the manila folder, set down a blank page and pencil, and point to the first clue trail blank: _____.

Writer: with the adult, make up a gentle mitten-market clue trail on paper without using real details: _____.



Mitten Market Lost Ticket

First clue First clue: choose the mitten tag, folded ticket, or small booth mark that starts the clue trail: _____ _____	Next clue Next clue: add the next paper clue that follows the mitten tag to another pretend market spot: _____ _____
Turning clue Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the folded ticket points to a different mitten clue: _____ _____	Mismatch clue Mismatch clue: write one pretend tag or ticket clue that almost fits but needs help from another paper clue: _____ _____
Return clue Return clue: bring back the first mitten tag and show how it helps the clue trail make sense: _____ _____	Folder label Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for the Mitten Market Lost Ticket manila folder: _____ _____

Quiet option: draw or write one mitten clue and one folder label word for the clue trail: _____.

Take-home line: keep the page in the manila folder and add one pretend lost-ticket clue later: _____.

Cloudberry Clocktower Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one manila folder, blank page, pencil, and this clue trail card beside a pretend clocktower note: _____.

Writer: with the adult, build the clue trail on paper using only invented clocktower details: _____.



Cloudberry Clocktower

First clue
First clue: choose the clock hand mark, bell-card symbol, or stair label that begins the clue trail:

Next clue
Next clue: add the next paper clue that follows from the clock hand mark to another pretend tower detail:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the tower clue changes direction on the page:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: name one bell-card symbol or stair label that almost fits but needs a new paper note:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first clocktower clue and explain why it belongs in the clue trail:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for the Cloudberry Clocktower manila folder:

Quiet option: write only the clocktower mark, the return clue, and one folder label word: _____. **Take-home line:** put the page into the manila folder and continue the paper clue trail later: _____.

Rain Boot Route Rangers Story Clue Trail Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out the manila folder, blank paper, pencil, and card before the invented rain-boot clue trail begins: _____.

Writer: with the adult, keep the clue trail on paper and make every ranger mark pretend: _____.



Rain Boot Route Rangers

First clue
First clue: choose the boot print, puddle mark, or paper sign that starts the clue trail:

Next clue
Next clue: add the next paper clue that follows the boot print to another invented ranger mark:

Turning clue
Turning clue: invent the calm moment when the boot print points to a different paper sign:

Mismatch clue
Mismatch clue: write one puddle mark or paper sign that almost fits but needs a clearer clue:

Return clue
Return clue: bring back the first boot print and show how it connects the clue trail:

Folder label
Folder label: write the broad pretend folder label for the Rain Boot Route Rangers manila folder:

Quiet option: write one boot print clue, one return clue, and one folder label word: _____. **Take-home line:** tuck the page into the manila folder and add one made-up rain-boot clue later: _____.